

Saturday, 25 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 29° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 26° 16°	MANCHESTER Drizzle 22° 16°	GLASGOW Light rain 18° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A record 165 migrants have arrived in the UK on a single dinghy, sparking renewed concerns about Channel crossings.

The vessel was reportedly the size of a standard bus, at 13 metres long. This incident highlights the ongoing challenges facing authorities.

IMMIGRATION · UK
- 2

The family lawyer for Southport killer Axel Rudakubana claims he is 'manipulating the system' after being moved to a secure psychiatric hospital.

Rudakubana was transferred from prison to a Berkshire hospital on Thursday. The move has raised questions about the justice system.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Several police officers were injured when a police boat crashed into Westminster Bridge.

Police confirmed a number of officers entered the water following the collision. They were all recovered safely.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 4

A father who murdered his four-week-old son has been jailed for 18 years.

Tony Bartlett, who had been drinking heavily, inflicted severe injuries on baby Atticus. This tragic case has shocked the community.

CRIME · UK
- 5

UK mortgage rates have risen to their highest level in a month, impacting homeowners and prospective buyers.

Renewed tensions in the Middle East are contributing to the increased costs faced by lenders. This will likely push up borrowing costs for consumers.

ECONOMY · UK

What's coming up

1 **Actress Jaime Winstone, known for her roles in EastEnders and Made in Dagenham, has joined the Strictly Come Dancing line-up.**

She is the eighth celebrity to be confirmed for the new series. Fans are already speculating about her dance partner.

ON AIR – Who do you think Jaime Winstone will be paired with on Strictly, and how far do you think she'll go?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Charli XCX's new album, 'Music, Fashion, Film', is out now, promising a deep dive into her life after the success of 'Brat'.**

The star's latest work is said to strip away artifice to examine her personal experiences. It's already generating a lot of buzz.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of Charli XCX? What are you hoping for from her new album, and what's your favourite track so far?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

3 **The popular football game EA FC has received a new age rating of 16+ following changes to loot box rules.**

The game's popular Ultimate Team mode is the reason for the higher rating from PEGI. This reflects growing concerns about in-game purchases.

ON AIR – Do you think the new 16+ age rating for EA FC is fair, given the loot box controversies? Does it affect whether you'd let younger family members play?

GAMING · NEW RELEASE

4 **UK rapper Megan Da Savage has thanked Linkin Park for 'changing her life' after Mike Shinoda gave her a freestyle shoutout.**

Shinoda spotted Megan Da Savage's rap on an independent music platform. This kind of recognition can be huge for emerging artists.

ON AIR – It's always great to see established artists championing new talent! Who are some of your favourite emerging artists right now?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5 **The cast of a groundbreaking BBC LGBT dating show say the final season is 'bittersweet'.**

They're sharing the impactful stories from the show. It's been praised for its representation and positive influence.

ON AIR – What impact do you think shows like this have had on representation and understanding? What other groundbreaking shows are you looking forward to?

TV · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Lewis Hamilton has led a Ferrari one-two in Friday practice at the Hungarian Grand Prix, showing strong form for the weekend.**

His team-mate Charles Leclerc followed closely behind. This bodes well for Ferrari fans ahead of qualifying.

ON AIR – Can Lewis Hamilton convert this practice form into a win in Hungary? Do you think Ferrari has found their stride this season?

F1 · UK

2 **The trend of low scores in The Hundred continues, with Birmingham Phoenix all out for just 64 in a nine-wicket defeat.**

They lost heavily to Trent Rockets at Edgbaston. This raises questions about batting performances in the tournament.

ON AIR – Are these low scores making The Hundred less exciting, or do you enjoy the tactical battles? What's your favourite aspect of The Hundred?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Newcastle United have sealed a £34m move for Monaco midfielder Aladi Bamba, with the fee potentially rising further.**

This is a significant signing for Newcastle as they look to strengthen their squad. Fans will be eager to see him in action.

ON AIR – What do you make of Newcastle's new signing, Aladi Bamba? Do you think he's worth the £34m, and how will he fit into the team?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Chelsea have agreed a deal to sign France defender Maxence Lacroix from Crystal Palace after two impressive seasons.**

Lacroix has been a standout performer for Palace. This transfer marks another key acquisition for Chelsea.

ON AIR – Is Maxence Lacroix the right fit for Chelsea's defence? What impact do you think he'll have at Stamford Bridge?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **All five Scottish teams involved in European competitions have postponed their Premiership matches scheduled for Saturday, 22 August.**

This decision allows them to focus on their European fixtures. It's a common move for clubs balancing domestic and continental commitments.

ON AIR – Do you think postponing league matches is the right decision for Scottish clubs competing in Europe? Or should they be able to manage both?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The enduring appeal of handwritten letters is making a charming comeback, with many rediscovering the joy of a personal touch.**
Amidst the digital deluge, sending and receiving a thoughtful, handwritten note is increasingly seen as a cherished and personal gesture.
- 2 New research suggests that spending time near 'ancient trees' can have a surprisingly calming effect on our minds.**
Studies indicate that the presence of mature, established trees contributes to a sense of peace and wellbeing, possibly due to their sheer scale and history.
- 3 The humble 'garden shed' is undergoing a stylish transformation, evolving into bespoke home offices and creative retreats.**
No longer just for tools, sheds are being repurposed as tranquil spaces for hobbies, remote work, or simply a quiet escape at the bottom of the garden.
- 4 A recent study highlights the mood-boosting power of 'nostalgic smells', such as freshly cut grass or old books.**
Researchers found that certain familiar scents can trigger positive memories and significantly uplift our spirits throughout the day.
- 5 There's a growing trend for 'micro-adventures' – short, local explorations that offer a taste of adventure without extensive travel.**
People are embracing the fun of discovering hidden gems close to home, from wild swimming spots to lesser-known walking trails, making the most of their weekends.
- 6 The simple pleasure of 'watching trains go by' is experiencing a quiet resurgence as a meditative pastime.**
Many are finding a surprising sense of calm and nostalgia in observing the rhythmic passing of trains, a gentle antidote to modern hustle.
- 7 Scientists have found that looking at photos of 'beautiful landscapes' can actually reduce feelings of stress and anxiety.**
Simply viewing images of natural scenery, even on a screen, has been shown to have a restorative effect on our mental state, helping us feel more relaxed.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to remember where we parked the car, even though we know it makes no logical sense?

ANSWER: CLICKING THE CAR ALARM BUTTON REPEATEDLY, HOPING TO HEAR THE BEEP (EVEN IF YOU'RE TOO FAR AWAY TO HEAR IT).

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, hot cup of tea. What is it?

ANSWER: STIRRING IT AN EXACT NUMBER OF TIMES, OR IN A SPECIFIC DIRECTION, BEFORE THE FIRST SIP.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'smell' instantly transports you back to a specific memory or a moment in time?**
Whether it's the scent of freshly baked bread taking you to Grandma's kitchen, or a certain perfume reminding you of a dear friend, what's a smell that holds a special memory for you, and what story does it tell?
- **Think about those 'everyday objects' that you just can't seem to part with, not because they're valuable, but because they simply make you smile or bring you comfort.**
Maybe it's a chipped mug, a well-worn blanket, or a slightly wonky garden ornament. What's an object you cherish for its sentimental value, and why is it so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There are more trees on Earth than stars in the Milky Way galaxy.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts grow several centimetres taller in space due to the lack of gravity compressing their spines, but shrink back to their original height upon returning to Earth.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.6 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.6 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of rhinoceroses is collectively known as a 'crash'.
- The inventor of the Pringles can, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one of his own cans.
- The world's quietest room is located at Microsoft's headquarters in Washington state, where background noise is measured in negative decibels.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar.
- The Bayeux Tapestry is not actually a tapestry, but an embroidery, nearly 70 metres long.
- Humans share 50% of their DNA with a banana.
- The longest place name in the world is Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu, a hill in New Zealand.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.

On this day

Day 206 of the year, 159 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anne (Eastern Christianity); Christian feast day: Carmen Salles y Barangueras; Christian feast day: Christopher (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Cucuphas. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1935 — Barbara Harris, American actress and singer (died 2018)
- 1979 — Tom Lungley, English cricketer and umpire
- 1923 — Estelle Getty, American actress (died 2008)
- 1948 — Steve Goodman, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1984)
- 1973 — David Denman, American actor
- 1984 — Zawe Ashton, British actress
- 1985 — Shantel VanSanten, American actress and model
- 1953 — Joseph A. Tunzi, Chicago based author, foremost expert on Elvis Presley

THE DAY TODAY

- 1957 — The Tunisian King Muhammad VIII al-Amin is replaced by President Habib Bourguiba.
- 1973 — Soviet Mars 5 space probe is launched.
- 1956 — Forty-five miles south of Nantucket Island, the Italian ocean liner SS Andrea Doria collides with the MS Stockholm in heavy fog and sinks the next day, killing 51.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1979 — In accord with the Egypt–Israel peace treaty, Israel begins its withdrawal from the Sinai Peninsula.
- 1965 — Bob Dylan goes electric at the Newport Folk Festival, signaling a major change in folk and rock music.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1969 — Vietnam War: U.S. President Richard Nixon declares the Nixon Doctrine, stating that the United States now expects its Asian allies to take care of their own military defense. This is the start of the "Vietnamization" of the war.
- 1993 — Israel launches a massive attack against Lebanon in what the Israelis call Operation Accountability, and the Lebanese call the Seven-Day War.

- 1957 — The Tunisian King Muhammad VIII al-Amin is replaced by President Habib Bourguiba.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 207 of the year, 158 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Andrew of Phú Yên; Christian feast day: Anne and Joachim (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Bartolomea Capitanio; Christian feast day: Blessed Camilla Gentili. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — Kate Beckinsale, English actress
- 1961 — Gary Cherone, American singer-songwriter
- 1957 — Nana Visitor, American actress
- 1967 — Jason Statham, English actor
- 1950 — Nicholas Evans, English journalist, screenwriter, and producer (died 2022)
- 1979 — Juliet Rylance, English actress
- 1986 — John White, English footballer
- 1950 — Susan George, English actress and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1958 — Explorer program: Explorer 4 is launched.
- 2009 — The militant Nigerian Islamist group Boko Haram attacks a police station in Bauchi, leading to reprisals by the Nigeria Police Force and four days of violence across multiple cities.
- 1968 — Vietnam War: South Vietnamese opposition leader Trương Đình Dzu is sentenced to five years hard labor for advocating the formation of a coalition government as a way to move toward an end to the war.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1993 — Asiana Airlines Flight 733 crashes into a ridge on Mt. Ungeo on its third attempt to land at Mokpo Airport, South Korea. Sixty-eight of the 116 people on board are killed.
- 1989 — A federal grand jury indicts Cornell University student Robert T. Morris, Jr. for releasing the Morris worm, thus becoming the first person to be prosecuted under the 1986 Computer Fraud and Abuse Act.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 31 Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7 Once Upon a Time in a Cinema

FRI 14 Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie

FRI 21 Mutiny; The Bride!

FRI 28 Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4 Conjuring: Last Rites

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026

4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)